

Discovery Question Map

Cheat Sheet - Skill: discovery - Difficulty: intermediate - Est. 6 min

Draft resource pending human editorial review - not yet professionally verified.

A map of open questions across five areas - situation, problem, impact, goal, and next step - for a scheduled discovery conversation, so you explore instead of interrogate.

Learning objectives

- Cover five discovery areas with open questions
- Move from facts to impact naturally
- Avoid yes/no and leading questions
- Follow the prospect rather than a checklist

The map

Area	Example question
Situation	"How is this handled today?"
Problem	"Where does that tend to break down?"
Impact	"When it breaks, what does it cost you in time or stress?"
Goal	"What would good look like six months from now?"
Next step	"What would make it worth exploring further?"

Use it well

- This is for a booked discovery call, not a cold-call interrogation.
- Ask one question, then actually listen and follow the answer.
- You do not need every question - depth beats coverage.

Worked example

Situation: "How do you schedule drivers now?" -> "Spreadsheets." Problem: "Where does that get painful?" -> "Last-minute changes." Impact: "What does a bad week cost you?" -> "Overtime and missed pickups." That thread is worth more than firing all five questions in order.

Safe-practice note

Discovery is a conversation, not a checklist to power through. Do not use it to trap someone with leading questions. Only use it when a discovery call is actually scheduled and welcome.

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